

ECOL 592: The Science and Policy of Species Conservation
Week 2: Listing Activity Worksheet

Name(s) _____ Petitioned organisms: _____

Who are the first three named petitioners on your document? What groups do your petitioners represent?

Which of the 5 factors of risk assessment does the petition cite as driving the focal organisms' decline? They are reprinted below for ease. If you select option 5, name the "other" factor:

1. The present or threatened destruction, modification, or curtailment of its habitat or range;
2. Overutilization for commercial, recreational, scientific, or educational purposes;
3. Disease or predation;
4. The inadequacy of existing regulatory mechanisms; and
5. Other natural or manmade factors affecting its continued existence.

Are all the factors given equal weight?

What taxonomic designation do you petitioners give the focal organisms? What kind of evidence is used to support the petitioners' claim?

Did your petitioners make any obvious arguments that relied on (or echoed) any of the kinds of value intrinsic to all species that were mentioned in Section 2 of the ESA? (Hint: They are "esthetic", "ecological", "educational", "historical", "recreational" and "scientific".)

After answering the previous questions, access the Federal Register's website or [regulations.gov](https://www.regulations.gov) to check out the outcome of your petition. First, try searching for the "Notice of 90-Day Finding" related to your petition. Were your organisms deemed potentially listable? What reasons did the agency provide for their decision?

Does your organism have a Species Status Assessment?

Does it have a recovery plan? If there is a recovery plan, how long after the species was listed did it get published? If there is no recovery plan, how long has your species been listed?